PGDM Dissertation Policy & Procedural Guidelines (Batch 2025–2027)

1. What is a Dissertation?

A dissertation is an independent, rigorous, and scholarly research-based project undertaken by PGDM students as a mandatory project to their postgraduate program. It provides students with the opportunity to apply theoretical concepts, analytical frameworks, and research methodologies learned in the classroom to solve complex, real-world business and management problems.

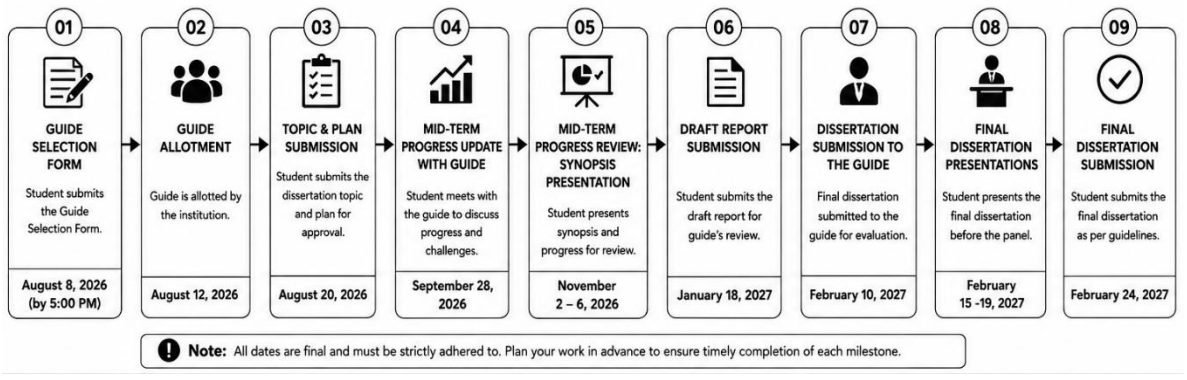
2. Academic Importance & Graduation Requirement

- **Credit Weightage:** The dissertation project carries **6 credits**.
- **Mandatory Status:** Completion and successful defense/submission of the dissertation are **strictly mandatory**.
- **Graduation Condition:** Passing this component is a prerequisite for graduation. **Without successful completion, a student cannot graduate from the PGDM program**, and their final degree will be withheld.

3. Guide Allotment & Regular Consultation

Faculty guides will be allotted to students based on their chosen stream, specialization, and research topic preferences. Once assigned, students are required to maintain consistent communication and regular consultations with their guide throughout the research lifecycle, adhering strictly to all institutional milestone checkpoints.

4. Dissertation Timeline & Key Deadlines



Milestone / Event	Action Required	Deadline
Guide Selection Form	Academic Office will circulate a Google Form. Students must fill in their preferences and details.	**August 8, 2026** (by 5:00 PM)
Guide Allotment	The Academic Office will officially assign faculty guides to students.	**August 12, 2026**
Topic & Plan Submission	Discuss with the allotted guide, finalize the research topic, and submit the structured project plan along with key milestone dates.	**August 20, 2026**
Mid-Term Progress Update with Guide	Mandatory checkpoint with your faculty guide to review initial data collection, literature review progress, and research direction.	**September 28, 2026**
Mid-Term Progress Review: Synopsis Presentation	Students present their interim findings, data collection status, and literature review progress to an internal committee or their guide to ensure the research is on the right track.	**November 2 – 6, 2026**
Draft Report Submission	A complete draft submitted to the respective faculty guide for preliminary review, corrections, structural editing, and plagiarism/anti-plagiarism checks.	**January 18, 2027**
Dissertation Submission to the Guide	Upon completion of the research, students are required to submit the finalized dissertation report in spiral binding directly to their concerned faculty guide for final evaluation.	**February 10, 2027**
Final Dissertation Presentations	A presentation and defense of the dissertation work before an expert panel or external evaluator to secure the final **6 credits**.	**February 15 -19, 2027**
Final Dissertation Submission	Final submission of the completed dissertation report to the Academic Office.	**February 24, 2027**

5. Non-Compliance & Consequence Policy

5.1 Missed Guide Updates / Progress Check-Ins:

5.1.1 Mandatory Communication: Regular check-ins with your assigned faculty guide are critical to ensure your research is progressing in the right direction.

5.1.2 Consequences of Missing a Check-In:

- **Formal Warning / Notice:** If a student fails to update their guide by the designated milestone date, the guide may issue an informal warning or report the inactivity to the Academic Office.
- **Academic Hold on Final Submission:** Guides have the authority to **withhold their signature/approval** for the final report if they have not overseen the student's progress throughout the tenure. Without the guide's sign-off, the final dissertation cannot be submitted on February 10, 2027.
- **Compulsory Catch-Up Plan:** The student will be required to submit a detailed recovery/catch-up plan immediately, and failure to catch up may lead to a delayed final submission or referral to the academic committee.

5.2 Withholding of Degree: Failure to submit the final dissertation project by **February 10, 2027**, will result in the student being ineligible for the current graduation cohort.

5.3 Delay Consequence: The student will be required to wait until the **next academic term** to officially submit their dissertation, during which time their final degree will remain withheld.

6 Integration of Internship Work into Dissertation Policy:

Students are permitted to integrate their ongoing corporate internship work into their dissertation project, provided that **both the student and the assigned faculty guide mutually agree** that sufficient academic depth, rigor, and research scope exist within the internship responsibilities.

Scope & Academic Rigor: The internship-based dissertation must go beyond routine daily job tasks. It must incorporate structured problem-solving, data analysis, literature review, and an applied management framework relevant to the student's stream.

Guide Approval: The decision to convert internship work into a dissertation topic must be officially communicated and approved during the topic and plan submission phase (**August 20, 2026**).

7. Scope of the Dissertation Project: General Scope & Methodological Guidelines:

7.1.1 **Discouraged Approaches:** Literature reviews and bibliometric studies alone are not encouraged.

7.1.2 **Original Research Requirement:** Students are expected to pursue original empirical research using pre-validated tools in their chosen area, subject to the explicit approval of their faculty guide.

7.1.3 **Specialized & AI-Driven Projects:** Students wishing to undertake individual analytical work or develop AI-driven automation tools are permitted to do so only under specific circumstances and with strict institutional and guide monitoring.

8. Guidelines Specific to Finance Specialization Students

Finance dissertation projects must demonstrate rigorous analytical depth, financial theory application, and empirical investigation into financial markets, corporate structures, or economic systems.

8.1 Recommended Research Areas & Scope

Students can explore topics aligned with, but not limited to, the following finance domains:

- **Corporate Finance:** Capital structure optimization, dividend policy decisions, mergers and acquisitions (M&A) performance evaluation, working capital management, and corporate restructuring.
- **Financial Markets & Investment Analysis:** Portfolio optimization strategies, asset pricing models, behavioral finance trends, market anomaly investigations, and equity or bond valuation.
- **Risk Management:** Credit risk modeling, market volatility analysis, liquidity risk assessment, and enterprise risk management frameworks in financial institutions.

- **Fintech & Banking:** Adoption and impact of digital payments, blockchain applications in banking, peer-to-peer lending dynamics, and algorithmic trading performance.
- **Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) Finance:** Impact of ESG ratings on firm performance, green bonds issuance, and sustainable investing portfolios.

8.2 Methodological Expectations

- **Quantitative & Empirical Rigor:** Purely descriptive or narrative literature reviews are discouraged. Finance dissertations must rely heavily on empirical data analysis, utilizing quantitative financial models and statistical tools.
- **Data Sources:** Students should leverage reliable secondary financial databases (e.g., corporate financial statements, stock exchange data, Bloomberg, Prowess, or macroeconomic indicators) or structured primary surveys where applicable.
- **Analytical Tools:** Application of statistical and econometric packages (such as Excel, SPSS, R, Python, or Stata) for hypothesis testing, regression analysis, or financial modeling is expected, subject to the approval of the faculty guide.

9. Originality & Plagiarism Threshold

Students must ensure the absolute originality of their research. The final report must pass institutional anti-plagiarism checks, maintaining a **strict maximum plagiarism threshold of 15%**; submissions exceeding this limit will be subject to immediate rejection.

10. Placement Eligibility

Timely submission, active compliance with project timelines, and satisfactory performance in the dissertation are mandatory prerequisites for a student's eligibility to participate in final campus placements.

11. Industry Relevance & Publication Support

Students are strongly encouraged to pursue impactful research that offers meaningful insights or solutions for industry practitioners and policymakers. The Institute will provide active facilitation and platforms for high-potential projects to be presented or published at external academic and corporate forums.